

I left school at eighteen and went out into the world instead of staying in a classroom. Almost everything I know, I learned from someone who was good at something real and happy to share it.

I started cooking young. The first kitchens that took me on were over in Australia. Then I went to sea and cooked on boats for years, and after that the kitchen and the water were the same life for me.

I did my sailing school out in the sea of Thailand. I raced in the Atlantic once, the whole way from Barbados to Bermuda, days of nothing but open water. I freedived down into the cenotes in Mexico, windsurfed in the Caribbean and in the lagoons in Portugal. None of it off a screen. I learned it from people who actually did it, where they did it.

It was only after all that I went back to France, worked a Michelin kitchen, and got my WSET, the wine qualification, in Paris. So the serious training came late, not first. Then superyacht chef, which carried me everywhere: the Med, French Polynesia, the Marquesas, the Galapagos, the Falklands, Brazil, a lot of Southeast Asia. I trekked up into the Himalaya in Nepal, and into the jungle in Thailand and the Amazon. India stuck with me more than anywhere.

And everywhere I landed I did the same thing on my own time. I took cooking classes. I dug through the markets. I went looking for the tables that were the real thing, not the ones in the guidebooks. Every place had someone proud of their craft who would teach you, if you showed up and paid attention. I'd been doing this for years before it had a name. On the side I run Littoralicious, a food and yachting thing, and that's where the eye for it comes from.

A machine can do almost anything now, and that got me thinking about what actually meant something to me. It was the slow stuff, learned by hand, from people who cared, in a real place. Turns out I'd been doing it since I was eighteen. I wanted to help other people find it.

WHAT I BUILT

So I made EducatedTraveler. It's not a shop, it's more of a bridge. There's the Atlas, a map I check by hand of where a craft is actually alive, ranked by the people around it and not by who pays me. And the Circle, which introduces you to the teachers, the schools, and the people already there. It connects you. It doesn't sell you anything.

The things worth having, you earn by doing them next to someone, and that's getting rarer the more the world automates.

THE INVITATION

Have a look at the Atlas, join the Circle, or just tell us what pulls you. That's enough to start.

A place, a person, your people. Earned, not bought.